

PUTTING IT ALL TOGETHER

Each product you buy must fight for its place in your money box.

The food is now cooked. The rice, chapatti, dal, vegetables, fish, chicken, dahi, pickle, papad and sweets are all sitting in their containers. Who eats what and how much is a function of individual tastes and needs. A fifteen-year-old can eat however much of whatever. More likely she'll order pizza, sniffing in disdain at today's unexciting lunch. Let teenagers be and let's talk about a thali meal. Each food type has a certain place on the thali.

For example, you can't just make a meal of the pickle or the papad. You need the base of carbohydrates in the roti and rice. You need the protein in the dal and the meat. You need the minerals and vitamins in the veggies. You need the probiotics in the dahi. The pickle and the papad are the taste-kickers to give an extra heft to your meal.

Look at the different financial products as different food types – each has a role and solves a specific problem. You don't just buy a product because it is sold to you. ***Each product in your money box needs to justify its space. It has to fight with other products available to claim its place in your money box.*** The time has come to now begin filling the money box with products.

There are some basic features of a financial product that you must understand. We think finance is tough but it is actually not. We don't need the rocket science deals. We just need products we can understand.